

Herald



Herald — bherald Flavor Guide (Operator)

Field	Value
Revision	1
Created	2026-05-30
Last modified	2026-05-30
Status	active
Status summary	Nano-detail operator reference for bherald (Build Herald) — a CLI-only flavor (no HTTP serve mode; DefaultPort=0) for CI/test gates. Documents evidence-capture (§11.4.2 anti-bluff evidence requirement), test-tier-verify (§40.2 8-tier matrix per §11.4.27), the not-yet-implemented gate-retest (HRD-045), and version. ANTI-BLUFF: derived from the built bherald binary (bherald --help, per-subcommand --help, version --json) + commons/branding.go. The gates are PURE classifiers — they observe recorded outcomes and exit non-zero on a breach; they never run the suites themselves.
Issues	(none specific to this guide)
Continuation	Bump when gate-retest (HRD-045) lands.

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§1. What bherald is

bherald is **Build Herald** — flavor key b, prefix BHR, **CLI-only** (DefaultPort=0, no serve mode). Per commons/branding.go its mission is "CI/test bindings + test-tier verifier + evidence capture". It is invoked from a CI pipeline to assert two anti-bluff properties at the build

layer: that every PASS carries captured evidence (§11.4.2), and that a package covers the full §40.2 8-tier test matrix (§11.4.27). Both subcommands are **PURE** classifiers — they observe recorded state and exit non-zero on a breach; they never run the test suites.

Build it:

```
go build -o /tmp/bherald ./bherald/cmd/bherald
```

§2. The subcommand surface

Verbatim from bherald --help:

Subcommand	What it does	State
evidence-capture	Validate a CI gate PASS carries a recorded evidence artefact (§11.4.2)	live
test-tier-verify	Verify the §40.2 8-tier test matrix for a package (§11.4.27)	live
gate-retest	Re-run composite gate post-fix per §11.4.38 (alias shared with rherald)	not yet implemented — HRD-045
version	Print Build Herald version + build info	live
completion	Generate shell autocompletion (Cobra built-in)	live

§3. version

```
$ bherald version --json
{"arch":"arm64","binary":"bherald","build_time":"unknown","commit":"unknown dev"}
```

§4. evidence-capture

Validates the §11.4.2 recorded-evidence requirement (the §107 anti-bluff covenant at the CI layer): a gate/test reporting outcome=pass **MUST** carry a captured-evidence artefact. It observes the evidence state from --evidence-path (a present, non-empty file/dir ⇒ evidence captured) or --has-evidence, classifies through the HRD-021 binding, and **exits non-zero on a metadata-only / no-evidence PASS-bluff**. An honest FAIL passes the anti-bluff check (the gate correctly reported failure). PURE: it reads the recorded outcome + the presence of the artefact; it never inspects its bytes.

Flag	Meaning
--outcome string	The recorded gate outcome (pass/fail/error) (default pass)
--evidence-path string	Path to the captured-evidence artefact (present + non-empty ⇒ satisfied)
--has-evidence	Assert a captured-evidence artefact exists (test seam / operator override)
--test-id string	Test/gate identifier recorded in the §11.4.2 Subject (default test)
--emit	Also drive the §11.4.2 verdict as a real constitution event

```
bherald evidence-capture --outcome pass --evidence-path docs/qa/
HRD-100/transcript.jsonl --test-id HRD-100 || echo "PASS-
BLUFF"
```

§5. test-tier-verify

Verifies a package carries every tier of the §40.2 canonical 8-tier test matrix (unit / component / integration / contract / e2e_sandbox / e2e_live / mutation / chaos) per §11.4.27 (no-fakes-beyond-unit + 100% test-type coverage). It observes the present tiers from `--tier` (repeatable), `--tiers-file`, or `--all-tiers`, and **exits non-zero when any canonical tier is missing** — blocking the promotion. PURE: it classifies the recorded tier coverage; it never runs the suites.

Flag	Meaning
<code>--tier strings</code>	A present test tier (repeatable / comma-separated) from the 8-tier set
<code>--tiers-file string</code>	File listing present tiers (one per line; # comments allowed)
<code>--all-tiers</code>	Assert the full §40.2 8-tier matrix is present (test seam / operator override)
<code>--pkg string</code>	Package label recorded in the §11.4.27 Subject (default pkg)
<code>--emit</code>	Also drive the §11.4.27 verdict as a real constitution event

```
bherald test-tier-verify --pkg commons_messaging \
--tier
unit,component,integration,contract,e2e_sandbox,e2e_live,mutation,
```

§6. gate-retest (not yet implemented)

`bherald gate-retest` is present in the command tree but its help line reads "(not yet implemented — HRD-045)". It is an alias shared with `rherald gate-retest`; on `rherald` it is live (see `docs/guides/RHERALD.md §6`), but the `bherald`-side body is open work under HRD-045. Do not script against `bherald gate-retest` yet.

§7. References

- Source: `bherald/cmd/bherald/main.go + build_cmds.go`.
- Branding: `commons/branding.go` (flavor `b`, `DefaultPort=0`).
- Constitution bindings: HRD-021 §11.4.2 / §11.4.27; §40.2 8-tier matrix; HRD-045 (`gate-retest`).
- Companion flavor guides: `docs/guides/{PHERALD,SHERALD,CHERALD,RHERALD,IHERALD,SCHERALD,QAHERALD}.md`.

Sources verified

Verified 2026-05-30: internal doc — no external online sources. Every subcommand, flag, default, and live-vs-stub claim above was derived by running the built `bherald` binary (`bherald --help`; `bherald evidence-capture|test-tier-verify|gate-retest --help`; `bherald version --json`) and reading `commons/branding.go` on 2026-05-30. The `gate-retest not-yet-implemented` status is quoted verbatim from the

binary's own help line. No flags were invented. Re-verify whenever the bherald Cobra surface changes (notably when HRD-045 lands).